



Cynosure of all eyes: India and Hyderabad power-hitter Tilak Varma has been the most sought-after player in the Rajkot leg of the ongoing Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy. VIJAY SONEJI

In Hardik's slipstream and learning from august company!

Our correspondents bring you the highlights and intriguing moments, both on and off the field, from the **group-stage fixtures** of Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy.

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Playing in the Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy — India's domestic T20 competition — has made many Indian Premier League (IPL) and India stars accessible for domestic cricketers to gain insights and for Rajkot locals to collect selfies and autographs.

Hyderabad's Tilak Varma has been the most sought-after player in the Rajkot leg. The 22-year-old star remains busy after every matchday. Following his record-breaking 151 against Meghalaya, Tilak was inundated with selfie requests — first from opposition

players and then from locals. Later, he had lunch with a few Meghalaya players.

A similar pattern unfolds after each matchday. After the game against Bihar, roughly eight opposition players, including captain Sakibul Gani, gathered around him at the boundary. It was a lengthy chat; Tilak even took a five-minute break to remove his pads before continuing